

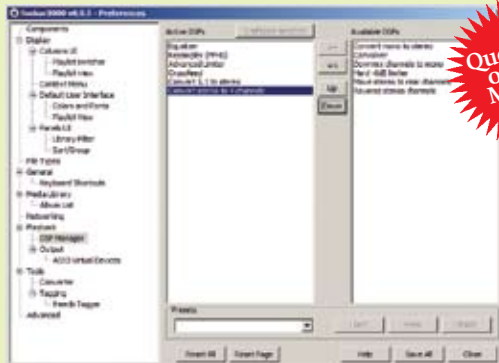
## 5.1 Channel System Not working!?

**Q** I have an AMD Athlon 64 X2 on an ASUS M2N-Sli Deluxe with 2 GB of DDR2 memory and an NVIDIA 7100GS graphics card. I have an Artis s5200 5.1 Channel Audio System. The motherboard has 8 channel support.

Till last month, I was using Windows XP with SP2 OEM. Everything was fine till then and my 5.1 audio system was working properly.

Now I have purchased Windows Vista Ultimate have installed all the necessary Drivers included on the Digit CD/DVD. When I configured my sound system to 5.1 channel on Vista, it worked fine when I checked every channel—rear, front, center and subwoofer. Every channel responded when I clicked on them.

When I play music on media players like Winamp and Windows Media Player, they play the sound tracks only on the front channels. The same goes for games. I have also installed the latest drivers. I have even tried to configure it to 7.1 channels



**foobar2000** allows replicating of front channels to the rear ones



I have turned the volume up to maximum everything has failed.

Also when I played movies in the *Godfather* game it shuts down due to unknown reasons, says Vista.

**Rushikesh**

As you know most of the music we listen to is stereo which means only 2 channels work. By default, players like Winamp and Windows Media Player will play the sound only through the front speakers. There is nothing wrong with your system as such. There are some plug-ins which can replicate the sound of the front speakers to the rear

speakers as well. foobar2000 ([www.foobar2000.org](http://www.foobar2000.org)) another audio player like Winamp comes with a plug-in that converts stereo music to 4.1. If you play stereo sound most of the time, then you can try unplugging the 3.5mm cables for the rear speakers from the sound card. If in the games you face the same problem, look for settings in the game as well to set the type of sound setup – headphones, 2.1, 4.1, 5.1 and so on.

The crash in Windows Vista could be due to incompatibility issues of the game or with the drivers installed on your computer.

## Request for Linux

**Q** I have broadband Internet connection and I want to download a Linux operating system. Please give me a solution.

**C Satyam**

**A** There are several Linux distributions for all kinds of tasks and users available on the Internet free for download. Some of these can be 100MB in size and some others can fit onto multiple DVDs at times. You should also know that we very often download Linux distributions and put them in our DVDs so you don't have to go through the trouble of downloading them. This month we've given you OpenSUSE 11.0, which is fairly easy for a newbie to get used to.

## New System Woes!

**Q** My desktop system configuration is Intel Core 2 Quad Q6600, ASUS P5N MX motherboard, 2 GB Transcend RAM, 360 GB Seagate SATA HDD, Zotac GeForce 9600 GT, Windows XP SP2. My problem is that when I play games like *Crysis*, *Assassin's Creed*, *NFS: Carbon* or any game for that matter, they crash leaving an error message "The program has encountered a problem and needs to close". Sometimes the game even freezes. I have checked my CPU temp in BIOS and it shows 48 degrees Celsius when the computer is idle and it goes upto 58 degrees Celsius while running games.

The same error appears when Firefox crashes. Also sometimes I get a blue screen and the system restarts. Is it a hardware problem?

This happens quite frequently and I have rein-



**SpeedFan** can detect sensors and display temperatures for components in your PC

stalled Windows XP SP2 some three times so far. How do I check my processor and graphic card temp? I bought this PC very recently. Help me!

**Shrey Chauhan**

**A** The Q6600 is in comparison a little hotter than some of the newer Core 2 Duos, but 58 degrees is still a pretty decent temperature. SpeedFan should be able to show you temperatures of your GeForce 9600GT. You haven't mentioned what power supply you own. If your power supply is under

450W, then it is likely the root of all your problems.

## This Boot Won't Walk

**Q** I have a 250 GB PATA hard disk in my PC. I want to connect another PATA hard disk in parallel which has some useful data. When I connect both of them I find a message of boot device error. Please tell me about the jumper settings also.

**M K VERMA**

**A** Set the hard drive with the operating system on it as the master and the other hard drive all the data as the slave. For the jumper configuration, you need to look at the top or the back of the hard drive. Next, make sure your boot configuration in your CMOS has been set to the drive with the operating system on it.

## Installing Ubuntu is now simpler than installing Windows

The partitioning of a drive is one of the most dreadful moments many users will go through during an installation of a Linux distribution. Space needs to be made, partitions need to be shifted, swap partitions need to be created. All this confusion leaves a lot of the users stranded and people lose data and partitions many a times. Virtualization is the only way of installing Linux without any risks.

### Wubi To The Rescue!

One of the new additions in the last few releases of Ubuntu is something called Wubi. Wubi allows you to install Ubuntu on Windows. It isn't just another launcher. Wubi will install Linux on your Windows partitions, into a single folder. That means that there is no need for partitioning.

### What Do You Need?

Firstly, you need Wubi which comes along with most Ubuntu releases these days. You can also download the 1 MB executable from [www.wubi-installer.org](http://www.wubi-installer.org). Make sure to download the right version of Wubi for the Ubuntu installation. Wubi can download the entire Ubuntu distribution over the Internet. If you have a fast Internet connection, then you can install Ubuntu without any installation discs. You can also use the ISO file without having to burn it on a CD or DVD. You should also be using the standard desktop version of Ubuntu rather than an alternate disc.

You require a partition with ample space for the distribution. The minimum size for the partition for Ubuntu using Wubi is 4 GB.

### Starting The Installation

If you have the downloaded disc image in the form of an ISO file, copy it to the same folder as the Wubi executable. The installation is pretty simple. Double click the Wubi executable and the installer will detect the ISO and start the installation.

This window will ask you to enter a few things. You need to enter a username and password for the OS. Remember this as you will need it to login into the distribution. You also need to enter a size for the distribu-



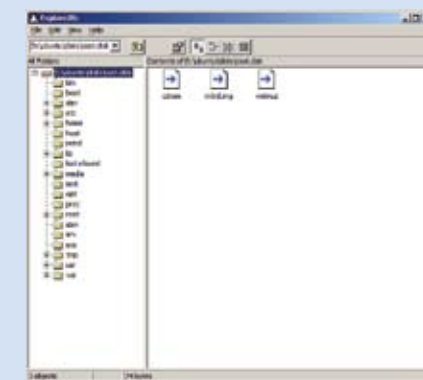
Installing Ubuntu using Wubi is extremely simple

tion. This will be the space that Wubi allocates for the distribution on the hard drive. Also, choose the location where you want Ubuntu to be installed. A folder will be created in its place with all the necessary partitions as files in it.

Click Install and the installation will begin. Ubuntu will make changes to the boot records and an option for booting into Ubuntu will appear the next time you reboot.

### Accessing Ubuntu Partitions From Windows

Once you start Ubuntu, you might want to get files that you were working on into Windows. To access files on demand in Windows, you need an application called Explore2fs ([www.chrysocome.net/explore2fs](http://www.chrysocome.net/explore2fs)). Run the application, click on File > Open Image file. Browse to the \Ubuntu\ disks in the location where Ubuntu



**Explore2fs** allows Linux file partitions to be read through Windows

was installed. Choose to display all kinds of files and select the partition you want to load. You should be able to view the files in it.

### Issues With Using Wubi

There is one problem that some might face while using Wubi and that is that the partition on which Wubi installs Ubuntu is not accessible once you boot into it. If that partition is extremely important and needs to be accessed in Ubuntu, then it is a good idea to create a small partition just small enough for the Wubi Ubuntu installation using a partitioning tool such as PartitionMagic for example. If you want something free, then try GParted (<http://gparted.sourceforge.net>). If you have a brand new hard drive, allot a small partition once you have the partitions made for Windows



**Gparted** is a free disk partitioning tool that can resize partitions as well

and for other data storage purposes. If you don't want to, you can manually mount the partition in Ubuntu.

The other minor issue is with the way Ubuntu is stored on the system. The large virtual disk files will get fragmented over time, so defragging is highly recommended or you might find some minor degradation in the performance of your Linux partition.

### Uninstalling Ubuntu

Wubi not only makes installing Ubuntu simple but uninstalling it also made easy. It can be done by removing the program on Windows. Boot into Windows and click on Start > Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs. Click on Ubuntu and click on Change/Remove. Click on Uninstall and Ubuntu will be removed from your computer. ☒

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